Mathematics Deputy Guild Lead Application

Math Guild App

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February 2026

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1 Common

1.1 New Initiatives and Changes

I'd continue with the Problem Sets and try not to stop them in middle as it happened in our tenure. As for the topics I'm planning to release a basket of all topics that come in SMMC (I feel that if we prepare for SMMC we can cover most of the topics in other competitions) and teaching sessions and corresponding Problem Sets can be done as per members' interests by choosing topics from the basket. And I'll make the PS corrections happen in the meets itself and maintain a leaderboard (depending on the competitions' quality, if too much RG happens might pack this idea). I'd try to make the guild more interactive by keeping biweekly/weekly meets and making sure each meeting goes for a while. In the meeting teaching sessions and PS corrections will be done. Something new I'd like to do is change the way of recruitment. Instead of keeping competition and then take people based on scores, we can call a few people who performed good in the competition and interview them and then take in. Or another way I feel is to do an app style recruitment but I feel keeping an timed competition is better. I've explained more about recruitment in further sections.

1.2 Competitions (March 2026 – May 2027)

Have put it in the calendar..

1.3 Engagement of Existing Members

I'd make them do more teaching sessions initially and also PS correction, rather than fully solving the PS-es. And they could be senior guide members in the guild itself because of the extra experience they have. While selecting for Inter IIT I'd first filter the interested people and then ask them if they're sure to join. Then I'd try to filter out based on interest and potential. Parallely while filtering, if anyone with good/better potential (than the ones already most likely in) I'd ask why not and try to convince to some extent. If they refuse or have some reason, then lite only. If there're no other volunteers then one of the leads would be joining. I'd also consider looking people outside the guild if they're interested and stay with us while we are preparing. Explained more about contingent recruitment later.

1.4 Contingent Strategist

I feel a Math Guild Lead should be able to both do and help peers with Math Competitions, which is our main goal. He should be able to be strong in a few Math topics but also enjoy intellectual discussion. As far as the non-technical part, he should have good relationship with the Tech Contingent Lead and be able to communicate well. Also any recruitment event should

have proper publi and proper announcements has to be made. They should also be able to have good planning ability for Problem/Teaching Sessions and also follow-through. And since this a learning guild the lead shouldn't be a headache to members. I feel I am suited for this role because despite being packed next semester I feel I can manage stuff the way current leads did and have a balanced acads, lead life. Also I like teaching math and intuitions to in some topics and can interact well too (I didn't expect I'll interact with 25B but somehow I did meet a lot of people), which means I have fairly decent communication skills. I also feel my plans are more dynamic so it won't be like a dictatorship. And I know the previous heads and guild leads quite well so any issues I can reach them out quite easily.

1.5 SWOT Analysis of Current Tenure

Strengths: Participation/Activeness was better than last tenure. Had performed good in competitions like SMMC, Mimamsa, SRMC and other MC events. There were decent number of PS-es and Teaching sessions as well. The recruitment competition had many participating people this time.
Weaknesses: Not all people were active, and infact some were completely mute. Some interested people had missed the guild recruitment due to information not being reached properly. Many people who performed good in the recruitment competition couldn't be joined due to size constraints.
Opportunities: The guild publi can be done more because some capable/interested people might miss out. The often-ity of meetings could be altered to biweekly. The style of recruitment can be changed, like interviews before taking the members in the competitions.
Threats: If strict rules are made to do work and the leads are serious, there's a possibility people leave and it will leave a bad impression on us. We might waste our time participating in some competitions which aren't worth us. Members might fake and not involve in any meetings/do work and it's hard to prove it and catch them.

2 Logistics

2.1 Tracking Member Progress

The current system initially followed a PS system so that everyone would take part in. But since that was online, many people didn't solve them and the idea was packed. I'm planning to keep a few learning sessions during online and a few PS-es during June/July. Then after we return, we can continue with PS-es weekly, so that we can ensure more active participation. And later on in the current tenure only a few more teaching sessions happened and I feel not many were involved after that. So I'd conduct a few offline teaching sessions as well and try to do the PS correction during the meet. For competitions I'd keep a meeting beforehand and discuss some plans/strats. I'll also keep an attendance kinda sheet to keep record of who all have attended the meetings or are active.

2.2 Yearly Calendar (March 2026 – May 2027)

Haven't mentioned meetings specifically but there'll be a meeting before each PS release (bi-weekly preferred) based on people's free time. The dates are supposed to be dynamic based on members' free times cuz they might have other club meets or CP contests.

2.3 Budget Plan

Attached excel sheet

2.4 Problem Sets

To be honest not much enthu was shown on problem sets. Like many didn't submit the PS-es and were ignoring. I'm planning to keep a PS every week. So while the PS is being made I'd keep a teaching session for the related topic during the meet and then release the problem set. I'd also add a few SMMC/Putnam questions on my own after reviewing the PS an the release it, so it'll prepare them for competitions. I'll keep a record of who all are doing the Problem sets and who aren't and whoever aren't I'll give them a warning if they ignore me. Too many warnings then maybe pack them too.

2.5 Teaching Sessions

I'd keep teaching sessions twice a week whenever we are doing PS review meet. The teaching session will be related to the Problem Set which is gonna be released that night and the next weeks', and the teaching session will be done by the PS setters or one of the leads/senior guild members. The main topics I want to cover are: Number Theory, Algebra, Integration, Geometry, Probability, Vector Algebra. For resources I'd prefer some sites like APMO questions' ideas as teaching, or PUTNAM questions. Some other references include IMO questions, AoPS. I don't want to use too many references as it is not practical to go through all of them to teach. But the ones I have mentioned so far are very standard references and cover almost all the topics. SMMC PYQ grind will be done one month before SMMC and will be kept a track of.

2.6 Internal Collaborations

Mimamsa already is there where math guild and biotech guild collaborate and form teams, but the issue is it's date. NSU crypto could be done along with cybersecurity guild but it is kind

of hard because of SMMC the previous day and most likely a quiz the very next day. If a few people don't have quizzes the next day then they can participate. AbhiPrajana could also be a Biotech, Math and Horizon collaboration and the date also seems fine.

2.7 External Collaborations

I don't see collab ideas outside insti beacuse due to our finite and limited time, we won't be able to achieve it. We'll have our sessions and problem sets, and then quiz week comes once in 4 weeks. So we basically have like 11 weeks a sem, hence it isn't feasible. I was told about the IITK math club SMMC prep colab idea but I feel it wouldn't last long due to timing overlaps. I want things to be practical and don't want things planned and then it getting canceled.

3 Competitions

3.1 Performance Analysis

Few of us lacked in some targeted competitions due to a bad day and few of us didn't prepare well enough. Although many had performed good there were still a few expected candidates who couldn't do as good as expected. We hadn't actively participated in many competitions during the winter like Mimamsa, LIMIT, IYMC R2. After talking to fellow members a few of them including me had the same reason that they couldn't participate because these were very close to the start of sem and many were packing. A few of them had told that they had forgotten. To ensure this doesn't happen in the upcoming tenure constant reminders will be given to everyone and put in the calendars (which was actually done in the current tenure as well, but we should still give constant reminders). But I feel in the end the vacation competitions its hard for a few people because it is right before sem starts and the dates just don't feel aligned. However interested people/people in campus will be giving them.

3.2 Comparison with Other Institutes

IITB, IITK and CMI generally have more percentage of olympiad trained guys more than us. We do have talent but I feel there are more outliers in these colleges. I feel whatever we train those guys are just too good because they're more used to competitions than us. If it is a non Olympiad style competition then we have chance but those guys are built different for Olympiads. We also have many really good people but the number isn't as much as these colleges. We can do our best by putting more effort in the training/problem solving culture by practicing Olympiad questions and put up a competition though.

3.3 Year-on-Year Performance

As an active group, from the fundaes I had gotten, guild has improved a lot from the previous tenure. Last time was much more active than the previous time (because that was the first time). As far as competitions I feel we had almost similar performances, our tenure had given more competitions but in the common ones (especially SMMC) he performance looked kinda similar. My opinion also matches that of the current heads and leads.

3.4 Personal Participation

I had participated in SRMC, SRMC Finals, St. Josephs, Integration Bee (went to 2nd round), Stamatics, Bids and Brains (went to final round), SMMC, IYMC prelims. I had missed NSU crypto because of quiz, IYMC finals and Mimamsa because of travel to insti, and LIMIT ISI because of travel with family during that weekend.

3.5 Compulsory Participation

Yes, in fact I'd still like the guild to be connected to the club and members attend MC competitions. But only if the competition feels worth it. It would be a training for our members and also see how they're performing. So I'd send the publi message in group saying "we aren't gonna judge but do give, it's helpful for us', and tell them about the event. By helpful events I mean: Integration Bee, SGR kinda event, SRMC, Bids and Brains (if repeated again) I wouldn't make it compulsory but MC events are mostly done in non-quiz time so if there's a good event I'd encourage my members to go and compete (and win hopefully).

3.6 SMMC Participation and Scheduling

Most of the guild members, but not all, participated in SMMC 2025. My teammate and I had prepared quite well for it but didn't manage to score well. A few people prepared well and also scored quite good. We had D slot exam right after SMMC. So I'd suggest to start SMMC prep a month ago and do for 2-3 weeks, and then prepare for quizzes. For the competitions during vacations like Limit ISI I'll make sure people register and give from their homes/hostel and for Mimamsa whoever is in insti I'll ask them to give if they're free.

3.7 Inter-IIT Strategy

After SMMC, of the interested candidates I'd keep a meeting with all of them. I'd prefer the ones in the guild and try to see how interested they are and how much they are willing to commit. I'll consider outside the guild (like ex-guild members too). I'll explain to them what commitments are to be made (stayback after exams, do grind) and try to see how serious they'll be. I'll tell them the perks and benefits/ privilege of attending such a competition. I'll also give priority to those who have more Olympiad experience. I feel more prior Olympiad experience and more enthu and more willing to commit - is where the balance would lie. If not many are even interested I'll try to convince them or else worst case one of the leads will be joining (like what happened last tenure). I don't think the plan in 2025 was flawed, just the bad case where not many were free/interested.

4 SRMC 2026

4.1 SWOT Analysis

Strengths: It had good participation overall and helped IITM and IITB collaborate to form good questions. The questions were also very good and it tests how good you are at selecting your questions rather than answering all of them.
Weaknesses: There were cheatings which couldn't be found because of non-existance of video proctoring. There were other issues with UNSTOP as well like them not releasing response sheets of candidates and then releasing certificates without license with IITM and IITB logos on it. And they also took too much time replying to mails.
Opportunities: A better platform with video proctoring will be good to prevent cheating. And since SRMC was a success last year we can expect more people to give this time and increase the prize pool (depends on sponsors).
Threats: The paper could get leaked by someone hence it should be confidential which means involving lesser members. Also there's a chance the sponsor tries to buy the club because of frequent sponsoring and it being a large sum.

4.2 Organizing Responsibilities

The guild leads will mainly be involved in problem setting of the prelims and finals. But they'll also have organization work. The heads will most likely dtake care of the platform part but if it takes too long or needs more than 2 people, then the guild leads will assist them by talking to the platform pre and post prelims. The guild leads also have to ensure all guild members give SRMC. If there's an issue while evaluating the leads might have to contribute to the checking of responses. And they also correct the questions they had set in the finals. But I feel the main responsibility of the guild leads would be to set questions.

5 HR and Recruitment

5.1 Past Recruitment Analysis

I couldn't speak to PK due to lack of time, but from our tenure I can make out some points. The issue with our recruitment was that it happened online for us and the 25B guys didn't have an interview. I think a rolling style guild should be there but not everyone who's interested deserves to be there, plus 26B has to be given chance and our guild shouldn't have more than 24 people. I feel around 4-5 people at max can be rolled and then fresh recruitment for the rest of the guild.

5.2 Member Categorization

I'd categorize guild members into two batches, the freshers and seniors. The freshers include who we are gonna recruit soon, and the seniors include the current/rolled members or those who have atleast 1 year experience. So it's not expected for the senior members to do the PS-es again but I'd recommend for them to try the red questions (even the leads are supposed to do). And the senior members are also supposed to the initial teaching sessions. They're also expected to guide the freshers. The freshers are supposed to solve the PS-es and listen to the teaching sessions (after a point they'll start to do teaching and setting PS). The guild should be like a family and no discrimination would be done.

5.3 Ideal Contingent Structure

Of the interested candidates I'd keep a meeting with all of them (after SMMC) (including the ones outside guild) and try to see how interested they are and how much they are willing to commit. I'll explain to them what commitments are to be made (stayback after exams, do grind) and try to see how serious they'll be. I'll also give priority to those who have more Olympiad experience. And all this I've mentioned above is if only if it's like the usual 2 people. If the plan changes then I'll have to call in more people. If not many are even interested I'll try to convince them or else worst case one of the leads will be joining (like what happened last tenure). I feel more prior Olympiad experience and more enthu and more willing to commit - is where the balance would lie

5.4 Recruitment Plan

I want to keep it dynamic. I'm okay for keeping a competition like last tenure but after the completion and evaluation take the top few people and interview them (unlike our tenure where the highest people were just selected), and take the people performed good in the interview. Or we can also keep an app and give a deadline and then take interviews based on the app

performance. I like the competition way of recruitment because it deals with how to choose questions for handling time pressure and the app style shows which topics you're comfortable with and your potential weaknesses. So I'd take ideas from my co-lead and senior members on what do I prefer.

5.5 Winter Inactivity

Yes, I feel guild has gone inactive last winter despite the leads trying to put questions daily (like AoC) there were no responses so the idea was packed. I think atleast 25B should have focused on worst case. Right after new recruitment (DGL) is done I think we should continue with PS-es atleast for a month to make sure 25B is active. In order to prevent this from happenening, for the summer break if the leads aren't free the senior guild members will be tasked to engage the new recruitees and same in the winter break.